tied up with TCS, along with other Indian companies. The company further entered into an agreement with InfoSpace, ‘a leading global provider of cross platform merchant and consumer infrastructure services’, to provide wireless services in Asia.

TCS also launched a ‘new $2 million global e-business development facility’ in Mumbai in the same year. It tied up with HDFC and formed a Rs 40 crore company, with equal partnership, to ‘provide IT-enabled services to overseas’ organizations. That year, the company’s revenue grew by more than six times over what it was in 1995.

Frenetic Expansion

To expand its geographical spread, TCS targeted emerging markets like China, Latin America and eastern Europe. Its efforts bore fruit when in 2001, it established its ‘first European nearshore development centre in Hungary’ and spread into the Asia-Pacific region by establishing regional headquarters in Singapore to focus mainly on the developing info-communications industry in the region.

TCS acquired the state-owned Computer Maintenance Corporation (CMC), which helped the company consolidate its position in the retail banking solutions space and bag some of the more prestigious projects in the country. These included the ‘largest banking software project in India, to implement a core banking solution at State Bank of India across 13,000 branches, including seven associate banks’.

Ratan’s twin strategy of expanding abroad and in India to achieve scale, yielded attractive dividends. In 2001, TCS also entered into a JV with Swedish Bank Skandinaviska Enskilda Banken (SEB), McKinsey & Company’s venture capital arm, Compass, and New-York based Ankar Capital to ‘develop wealth management products and services for leading Asian banks’. Alongside, it signed an agreement with Ericsson worldwide to ‘provide cost-effective solutions in telecom’.

The following year, it floated a new business model, branded as the Global Network Delivery Model (GNDM), to provide all its customers ‘one global service standard’. Pursuing this objective, TCS established its global development centre in Uruguay and started a wholly owned entity called Tata Information Technology, with an office in Shanghai and a global development centre in Hangzhou, China.